

COMSATS University Islamabad
Department of Software Engineering
Course: Introduction to Psychology

Class: BSE-8C

Assignment: 01

Topic: *Psychology Behind Software*

Due Date: Wednesday, 7th October 2026

Marks:

Name: Yawar Hussain

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Section: 8C

Assignment Question

How is Psychology involved in the software we use?

Choose **ONE digital product, application, website, or software feature** that you use in everyday life. Examples include:

- YouTube
- Instagram
- WhatsApp
- Google Maps
- University Portal
- Food-delivery apps
- Online learning platforms
- Mobile games
- Banking apps
- Notification systems

Analyse your chosen software from a **psychological perspective**.

Your task is to explain **how the software affects or responds to human behavior and mental processes**, and how understanding psychology could help improve it.

What You Have to Do

Answer the following questions about your chosen software:

1. What did you choose?

Write the name of the app, website, or software feature and briefly explain what it does.

Answer: Instagram algorithm which know exactly what I see also it suggest nearly precise reels which I want to see also it easy to use and give smooth performance

Example:

“I chose YouTube because it provides users with videos based on their interests and previous activity.”

2. Which areas of Psychology are involved?

Identify **at least TWO areas of psychology** that are relevant to your chosen software.

For example:

- Cognitive Psychology
- Social Psychology
- Developmental Psychology
- Personality Psychology
- Educational Psychology
- Health Psychology
- Industrial-Organizational Psychology

Do not simply name the areas. Explain briefly why they are relevant.

Social Psychology: it shows the social trending reels it also connects you with your friends and helps us to find new friends.

Example: you have a person you know each other but not friend Instagram recommends those person in your feeds which help to increase the social connection

Answer:

Personality Psychology: Trending reels and posts are highly reflective with our life

For example: If there is any song being trending there are a lot of people making reels using those songs

Even now most of people buy dresses or order foods after watching reels

3. What psychological process is involved?

Explain **what happens psychologically when a person uses the software.**

For example:

- Does it require attention?
- Does it involve memory?

- Does it influence decision-making?
- Does it affect motivation?
- Does interaction with other people matter?
- Does it influence learning or behavior?

Answer:

- According to study using small and funny reels give you short time happy and feel relax
- It also attracts user attention using this strong feeds algorithm so a person are stuck with this app
- It provides good user interface which can easily accessible for user even any new user can easily use it
- Some time it become a motivated a person when a person is start watching this kind of reels it show the motivational reels which help a person to get ideas and explore new things
- It is very good for social marketing

4. How could Psychology improve the software?

Suggest **ONE practical improvement** to your chosen software based on psychology.

For example:

“The university portal could make upcoming deadlines more noticeable because users may overlook important information when too much information is displayed at once.”

Answer: they already have lot of features which is necessary for user so I don't think there is any features missing or need to use because they already have:

Create groups, individual messages, private accounts, calling system, voice chats, advance camera filters, music and save etc..

5. Which research method could a psychologist use?

Choose **ONE research method** from Chapter 1 that could be used to study your chosen software.

Examples:

- Naturalistic Observation
- Case Study
- Survey/Interview
- Correlational Research
- Experiment

Briefly explain **why that method would be suitable**.

Ans: I choose the survey method

I Survey and Interview with my roommates and hostel friends majority of the users is Instagram. Also

Submission Requirements

- **Individual assignment**
- Length: **2–3 pages**
- No coding is required.
- No statistical calculations are required.
- Use concepts discussed in **Chapter 1**.
- Use clear headings.
- Give examples wherever appropriate.
- If you use information from sources outside the course material, mention the source briefly.mgt5

Suggested Structure

Your assignment can be organized as follows:

1. Introduction

What software/product did you choose?

2. Areas of Psychology

Which two areas are relevant and why?

3. Psychological Process

What happens psychologically when people use it?

4. Psychological Improvement

What ONE change would you suggest?

5. Research Method

How could a psychologist study this?

6. Conclusion

In a few sentences, explain why psychology is important when designing software for people.

Remember

You are not being asked to build software. You are being asked to understand the human being who uses it.

Rubric as a general Guideline

Criteria	Marks	What to look for
Understanding of Psychology		Correctly identifies and explains relevant psychological concept(s)/perspective(s).
Application to Software		Clearly connects the psychological concept to a specific feature, design, or function of the selected software/app.
Analysis & Examples		Goes beyond simply describing the app; explains <i>how or why</i> the psychological principle influences the user, with relevant examples.
Organization & Presentation		Clear structure, readable formatting, appropriate headings, and generally well-presented work.
Timely Submission		Submitted by the stated deadline.